

Graph Language

Study handout

Line graphs | Bar charts | Pie charts

Target: **Band 6 – 6.5**

What is inside

- 1 Task 1 basics** The rules, the 4-paragraph plan, the introduction and the overview
- 2 Up, down and steady** Trend words for line graphs
- 3 How big? How fast?** Adverbs, adjectives and numbers
- 4 Bigger, smaller, the same** Comparing in bar charts
- 5 Pieces of the pie** Proportions and fractions
- 6 Band 5 → Band 6.5** Common mistakes and how to fix them
- 7 Model answers** Five full examples with graphs
- 8 Practice and checklist** Quick checks, final checklist, Arabic glossary and answers

How to use this handout

Read one section after each app lesson.

Learn the words in **bold**. They are the words examiners want to see.

Copy the sentence patterns. Change the numbers and the topic.

Keep this handout next to you when you practise writing.

1 Task 1 basics

App: Lesson 1 · Meet the Graphs

Six golden rules

1	Write at least 150 words.	Under 150 words loses marks.
2	Spend about 20 minutes.	Task 2 is worth more. Save 40 minutes for it.
3	Always write an overview.	No overview can limit your Task Achievement score to Band 5.
4	Do not copy the question.	Copied words are not counted. Paraphrase.
5	Do not give your opinion.	Describe the data only. No "I think".
6	Check every number.	A wrong number is a wrong fact.

Know your graph

Graph	What it shows	Key language
Line graph	Change over time	rise, fall, remain stable, peak, fluctuate
Bar chart	Comparing amounts or groups	higher than, twice as many as, whereas
Pie chart	Parts of a whole (100%)	account for, a quarter, the majority

Part of a graph	Meaning	Arabic
vertical axis	the line up the side	المحور الرأسى
horizontal axis	the line along the bottom	المحور الأفقى
segment	one piece of a pie chart	جزء / قطاع
category	a group, e.g. food, rent, transport	فئة
figure	a number on the graph	رقم / قيمة
period	a length of time	فترة

The 4-paragraph plan

Paragraph	What to write	Start like this
Introduction	Paraphrase the question. 1 sentence.	The line graph illustrates...
Overview	2 main features. No numbers.	Overall, it is clear that...
Body 1	Details and numbers for the first group or time.	In 2010, ...
Body 2	Details and numbers for the second group or time.	In contrast, ... / By 2020, ...

Writing the introduction

Change the words of the question. Keep the meaning.

Question says	You write
The graph below shows...	The line graph illustrates ... / The bar chart compares ...
the number of visitors	how many people visited
the percentage of households	the proportion of homes
between 2010 and 2020	over a period of ten years, from 2010 to 2020
sources of electricity	where electricity came from

Example

Question: The line graph below shows the number of visitors to three museums in a city between 2010 and 2020.

Introduction: The line graph **illustrates how many people visited** three museums in a city **over a period of ten years**, from 2010 to 2020.

Writing the overview

Look at the graph for 10 seconds. Ask three questions:

- What is the **biggest** or the **smallest**?
- What changed the **most**?
- What is the **general direction**: up, down or the same?

Pattern: Overall, it is clear that + main feature 1, while + main feature 2.

Overall, it is clear that the Science Museum became more popular, **while** visitor numbers at the Art Gallery went down.

2 Up, down and steady

App: Lesson 2 · Up, Down and Steady

Trend words

Direction	Verb (past tense)	Noun	Arabic
 Up	rise → rose increase → increased grow → grew climb → climbed	a rise an increase growth –	يرتفع يزداد ينمو يصعد
 Down	fall → fell decrease → decreased decline → declined drop → dropped	a fall a decrease a decline a drop	ينخفض يتناقص يتراجع يهبط
→ No change	remain stable → remained stable level off → levelled off	– –	يبقى مستقرًا يستقر بعد تغيير
↑ Up and down	fluctuate → fluctuated	a fluctuation	يتذبذب
▲ ▼ Top / bottom	peak → peaked at reach a low → reached a low of	a peak of a low of	يبلغ الذروة يصل إلى أدنى مستوى

Two sentence patterns

Use both patterns. Variety helps your band score.

Pattern A verb	Sales rose to 500 units in 2019.
Pattern B noun	There was a rise in sales in 2019.

Watch out: irregular verbs

rise – **rose** – risen fall – **fell** – fallen grow – **grew** – grown
 ✗ rised ✗ falled ✗ grewed

Small words with trends

Pattern	Example
rose to + final number	Passenger numbers rose to 240,000 in 2015.
remained stable at	The figure remained stable at 45,000 for two years.
peaked at	Numbers peaked at 300,000 in 2019.
reached a low of	The figure reached a low of 120,000 in 2020.
fluctuated between	Prices fluctuated between \$60 and \$80.

3 How big? How fast?

App: Lesson 3 · How Big? How Fast?

From small to big

Adverb (+ verb)	Adjective (+ noun)	Meaning	Arabic
slightly	slight	a very small change	بشكل طفيف
gradually	gradual	slow, over a long time	تدريجياً
steadily	steady	the same speed every time	بثبات
significantly considerably	significant considerable	a large, important change	بشكل ملحوظ
sharply	sharp	big and fast	بشكل حاد
dramatically	dramatic	very big and sudden	بشكل هائل

The golden grammar rule

verb + adverb: Sales **rose sharply**.

adjective + noun: There was **a sharp rise** in sales.

✗ a sharply rise ✗ rose sharp

Numbers: from, to, by, at

Example: gym membership went from 1,050 in 2019 to 1,850 in 2020.

Word	Meaning	Example
from ... to	the start number and the end number	Membership rose from 1,050 to 1,850.
by	the size of the change (the difference)	Membership rose by 800.
to	the end number only	Membership rose to 1,850.
at	a level (peak, stable)	Membership peaked at 2,150.

Close, but not exact

Phrase	Real figure	Example
approximately / about / around	39%	Approximately 40% of students walked.
just over	52%	Just over half of the students chose English.
just under	48%	Just under half preferred tea.
nearly / almost	98	Nearly 100 people attended.

Percent or percentage points?

90% → 78% is a fall of **12 percentage points**.

Do not write "a fall of 12%". Use percentage points when you compare two percentages.

4 Bigger, smaller, the same

App: Lesson 4 · Bigger, Smaller, the Same

Example chart: students in four sports. **Men:** football 120, basketball 80, swimming 40, tennis 60. **Women:** football 30, basketball 60, swimming 80, tennis 60.

Comparison language

Language	Example	Arabic
higher / lower than	The figure for men was higher than the figure for women.	أعلى من / أقل من
the highest / the lowest	Football had the highest figure for men, at 120.	الأعلى / الأدنى
twice as many ... as	Twice as many women as men chose swimming.	ضعف عدد
compared with	120 men played football, compared with only 30 women.	مقارنةً بـ
exceed	Men exceeded women in basketball by 20.	يتجاوز
a gap between	The gap between men and women was largest for football.	فجوة / فرق بين

Linking words

Word	How to use it	Example
whereas / while	Joins two different ideas in one sentence.	Men preferred football, whereas women preferred swimming.
In contrast,	Starts a new sentence. Shows a difference.	Men chose football. In contrast , women chose swimming.
Similarly,	Starts a new sentence. Shows the same.	60 men played tennis. Similarly , 60 women played tennis.
respectively	Numbers in the same order as the groups.	Men and women played basketball: 80 and 60 respectively .

Number of or amount of?

	Use with	Example
the number of	countable nouns: students, cars, people	The number of cars doubled.
the amount of	uncountable nouns: water, money, time	The amount of water increased.

Compare. Do not just list.

- ✗ Men football 120. Women football 30.
- ✓ 120 men played football, **compared with** only 30 women.

5 Pieces of the pie

App: Lesson 5 · Pieces of the Pie

Verbs for parts of a whole

Pattern: category + verb + percentage + of + the total

Verb	Example	Arabic
account for	Housing accounted for 35% of spending.	يشكّل / يمثّل
make up	Children made up a quarter of the population.	يُكوّن
represent	The largest segment represents transport.	يمثّل
constitute (formal)	Women constituted 60% of the workforce.	يشكّل
the largest share of	Oil had the largest share of energy production.	الحصة الأكبر

Watch out

- ✗ accounted 45% ✓ accounted **for** 45%
- ✗ made up of 20% ✓ made up 20%

Fractions and words

Figure	Words	Arabic	Example
75%	three quarters	ثلاثة أرباع	Three quarters of the land was farmland.
over 50%	the majority	الأغلبية	The majority of students walked.
50%	half	نصف	Half of the budget went on rent.
33%	a third	ثلث	A third of employees worked from home.
25%	a quarter	ربع	A quarter of students took the bus.
20%	a fifth	خمس	A fifth of the electricity came from wind.
small %	a minority	أقلية	Only a minority cycled to college.

Useful extras

- **The remaining** 10% was spent on other items.
- 45% → **just under half**. 35% → **just over a third**.
- Two pie charts? Describe the change: The share of oil **fell from** 45% **to** 20%, **a drop of 25 percentage points**.

6 Band 5 → Band 6.5

Common mistakes from all five apps

Read the Band 5 sentence. Then study the better version.

✗ Band 5	✓ Band 6.5	Why it is better
The graph is about people and cars.	The line graph illustrates the number of people who owned a car in the UAE between 2000 and 2020.	It names the graph type, uses 'illustrates', and says what, where and when.
In the graph we see many things change.	Overall, it is clear that car ownership rose, while bus use fell over the period.	An overview states the main trends. Never give your opinion in Task 1.
The sales go up and up.	Sales rose from 200 to 500 units between 2015 and 2020.	Past tense verb (rose), real numbers and a time period.
Number of users was same in 2019 and 2020.	The number of users remained stable at 3 million from 2019 to 2020.	'Remained stable at' + the figure is clear and accurate.
The number go up very very much.	The number of users rose dramatically, from 1 million to 9 million.	One strong adverb replaces 'very very much', and the numbers prove it. 'A dramatically rise' is wrong: use an adjective before a noun.
There was a sharply fall.	There was a sharp fall in sales in 2021.	Adjective (sharp) before the noun (fall), and it says what fell and when.
Price rose 20 to 25.	The price rose from \$20 to \$25.	From + start + to + end. 'By \$20' would mean the price went up by 20 dollars.
Men football 120 women 30.	120 men played football, compared with only 30 women.	A full sentence with a verb, and 'compared with' links the two figures.
Women swimming is two times of men.	Twice as many women as men chose swimming.	The pattern is: twice as many + noun + as + noun.
Car is 45%.	Travelling by car accounted for 45% of all journeys.	'Accounted for' needs 'for', and the sentence says 45% of what.
Most people 70% walk.	The majority of people (70%) walked to work.	'The majority of' = more than half, and the figure supports it.
Solar go from 5% to 12%, it is 7%.	The share of solar power rose from 5% to 12%, an increase of 7 percentage points.	'Share', a correct verb and 'percentage points' for the difference.

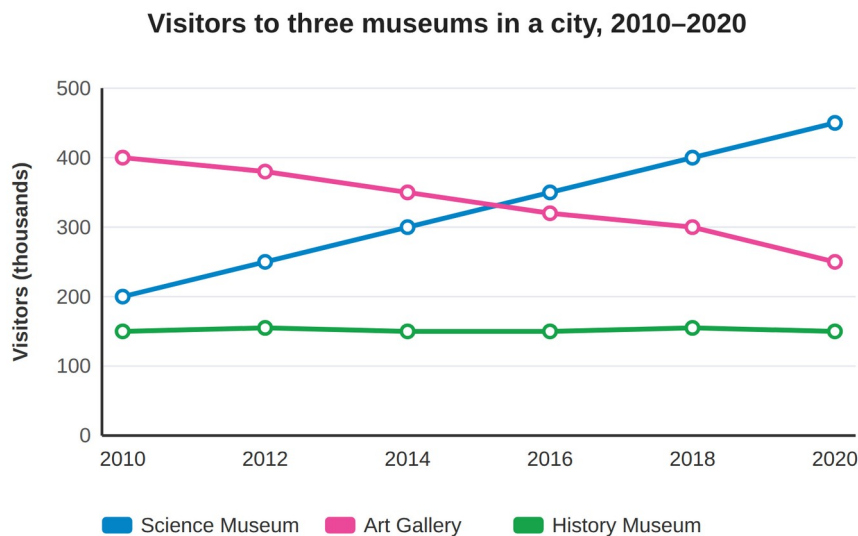
7 Model answers

Band 6.5 answers from the apps. The lesson words are in bold.

Model 1: Meet the Graphs (167 words)

Task

The line graph below shows the number of visitors to three museums in a city between 2010 and 2020. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.



Introduction

The **line graph illustrates** how many people visited three museums in a city over a **period** of ten years, from 2010 to 2020.

Overview

Overall, it is clear that the Science Museum became much more popular, while the number of visitors to the Art Gallery went down. The **figure** for the History Museum stayed almost the same throughout.

Body 1

In 2010, the Art Gallery was the most popular of the three museums, with **400,000 visitors**, compared with only 200,000 at the Science Museum. However, visitor numbers at the Art Gallery **went down** every two years and reached just **250,000** by 2020.

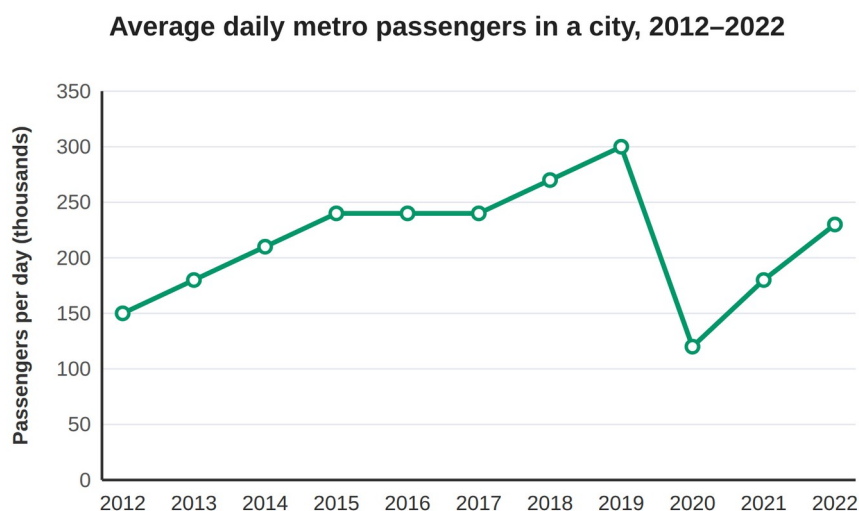
Body 2

In contrast, the Science Museum saw steady growth. Its **figure** went up by 50,000 every two years, and in 2016 it had more visitors than the Art Gallery for the **first time**. By 2020, it had **450,000 visitors**, which made it the most popular museum at the end of the **period**. Meanwhile, the History Museum had the lowest **figures** on the graph, with around 150,000 visitors each year.

Model 2: Up, Down and Steady (155 words)

Task

The graph below shows the average number of passengers who used a city's metro system each day between 2012 and 2022. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.



Introduction

The line graph illustrates the average number of people who travelled on a city's metro system each day over a ten-year period, from 2012 to 2022.

Overview

Overall, passenger numbers **increased** over the period as a whole, despite a sudden **drop** in 2020. The highest **figure** was recorded in 2019, only one year before this fall.

Body 1

In 2012, around 150,000 passengers used the metro every day. This figure **rose** to 240,000 in 2015, an increase of 90,000 passengers in just three years, and then it **remained stable** until 2017. After 2017, numbers **climbed** again and **peaked** at 300,000 in 2019.

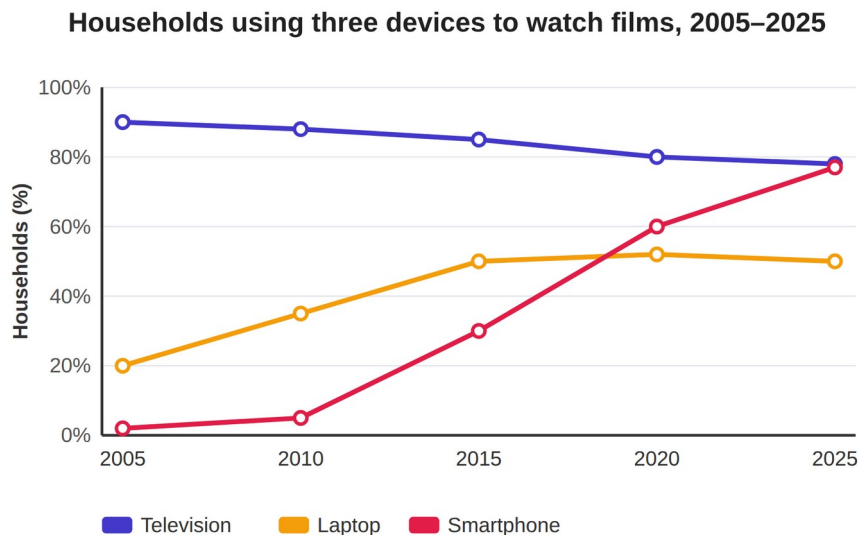
Body 2

In 2020, however, the number of passengers **dropped** suddenly and **reached a low of** 120,000. This was the only year in which the figure was below the level of 2012. After this, there was an **increase** in passenger numbers, which **grew** to 230,000 by 2022. However, this was still 70,000 lower than the **peak** in 2019.

Model 3: How Big? How Fast? (152 words)

Task

The graph below shows the percentage of households in one country that used televisions, laptops and smartphones to watch films between 2005 and 2025. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.



Introduction

The line graph compares the proportion of households in one country that watched films on televisions, laptops and smartphones over a twenty-year period, from 2005 to 2025.

Overview

Overall, televisions remained the most common device throughout the period. However, smartphone use rose **dramatically**, while the use of televisions fell **gradually**.

Body 1

In 2005, **approximately** 90% of households watched films on a television. This figure **declined gradually**, falling **by** 12 percentage points to 78% in 2025. Laptop use, by contrast, **increased sharply from** 20% **to** 50% between 2005 and 2015. After that, it changed only **slightly**, and it stood at 50% at the end of the period.

Body 2

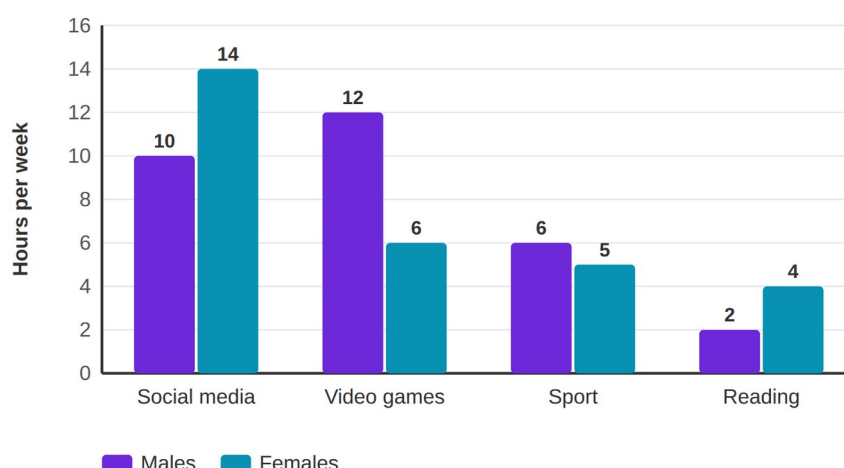
Smartphones showed the most significant change. Only 2% of households used them in 2005, and there was a **slight** rise to 5% by 2010. However, the figure then **rose dramatically** to 60% in 2020. By 2025, it had reached 77%, which was **just under** the figure for televisions.

Model 4: Bigger, Smaller, the Same (165 words)

Task

The bar chart below shows the average number of hours per week that young males and females in one country spent on four leisure activities in 2025. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Average hours per week young people spent on four activities, 2025



Introduction

The bar chart compares how many hours a week young men and women in one country spent on four free-time activities in 2025.

Overview

Overall, social media was **the most popular activity** for females, **whereas** males spent the most time playing video games. Both groups spent **the least time** reading.

Body 1

Females spent 14 hours a week on social media, **compared with** 10 hours for males. This was **the highest** figure on the chart. **In contrast**, video games were far more popular among males, who played for 12 hours a week. This was **twice as many** hours as females, who played for only 6 hours.

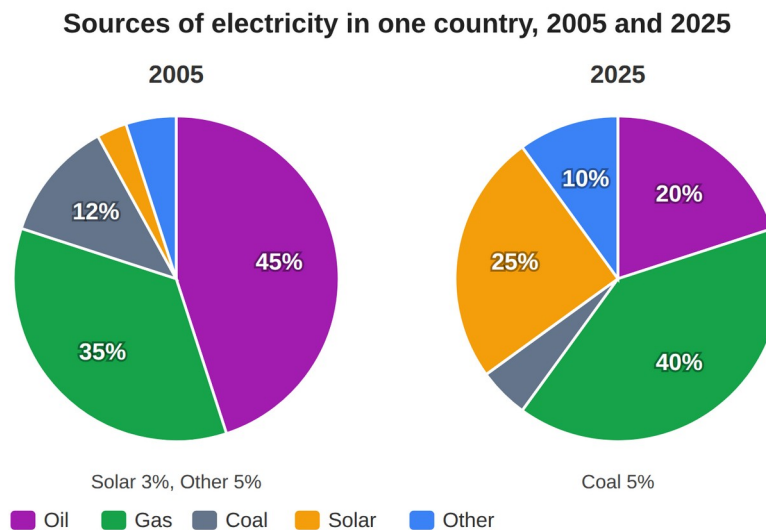
Body 2

The figures for sport were **similar**, at 6 and 5 hours for males and females **respectively**. Reading was the least popular activity, but females read for 4 hours a week, which was **twice as many** hours as males. The largest **gap between** the two groups was for video games, where the figure for males **exceeded** the figure for females by 6 hours.

Model 5: Pieces of the Pie (159 words)

Task

The pie charts below show the sources of electricity in one country in 2005 and 2025. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.



Introduction

The pie charts compare the proportion of electricity that one country produced from five different sources in 2005 and 2025.

Overview

Overall, gas replaced oil as the **largest source** of electricity, and solar power saw the most dramatic growth.

Body 1

In 2005, oil **accounted for** just under **half** of the country's electricity, at 45%, while gas **made up** just over **a third** (35%). Together, these two fuels produced **the majority** of all electricity. Coal **represented** 12%, and solar power **constituted** a very small **share** of only 3%. **The remaining** 5% came from other sources.

Body 2

By 2025, the picture had changed considerably. The **share** of gas rose slightly to 40%, which made it the largest source. In contrast, oil fell to **a fifth** of the total, a drop of 25 **percentage points**. The most noticeable change was in solar power, which grew to **a quarter** of all electricity. Coal fell to just 5%, whereas the figure for other sources **doubled** to 10%.

8 Practice and checklist

Test yourself, then check your writing.

Quick checks

Write your answers. The answers are on the last page.

Quick check: basics

1. Which paragraph must have **no** detailed numbers?
2. Paraphrase: "The chart below shows..." → The pie chart _____ ...
3. True or false? You should say which graph you like best.

Quick check: trends

1. Sales _____ (rise) sharply in 2019.
2. There was a _____ in visitor numbers. (drop)
3. The price went up and down many times. → The price _____ .
4. Numbers reached the highest point, 900. → Numbers _____ 900.

Quick check: size and speed

1. There was a _____ (sharp / sharply) rise in prices.
2. Sales rose _____ 200 _____ 300.
3. The price fell _____ \$5. (the difference)
4. The real figure is 59%. → _____ 60% of students were women.

Quick check: comparing

1. The _____ of money spent on food fell.
2. 80 women and 40 men chose swimming. → _____ women as men chose swimming.
3. Males and females spent 6 and 5 hours on sport _____ .
4. Car use rose. _____ , bus use fell. (new sentence)

Quick check: pie charts

1. 25% of students took the bus. → _____ of students took the bus.
2. Car travel accounted _____ 45% of journeys.
3. 45% is _____ half.
4. Solar power: 5% → 12%. This is an increase of 7 _____ .

Before you finish: check your answer

- ☐ I named the graph type and **paraphrased** the question.
- ☐ I wrote an **overview** with the main features and no small numbers.
- ☐ My body paragraphs have **numbers and years**.
- ☐ I **compared** the data. I did not just list it.
- ☐ I used **past tense** for past years (rose, fell, remained).
- ☐ I used an **adverb** with a verb and an **adjective** with a noun.
- ☐ My **numbers are correct**. I checked them twice.
- ☐ I did **not** give my opinion.
- ☐ I wrote **150 words or more**.

Arabic glossary

All the words from the five app lessons.

Lesson 1: Meet the Graphs

line graph	رسم بياني خطي	figure	رقم / قيمة
bar chart	مخطط بالأعمدة	percentage	نسبة مئوية
pie chart	مخطط دائري	proportion	نسبة / حصة
vertical axis	المحور الرأسي	period	فترة
horizontal axis	المحور الأفقي	illustrate	يوضح
segment	جزء / قطاع	compare	يقارن
category	فئة	overall	بشكل عام

Lesson 2: Up, Down and Steady

rise	يرتفع / ارتفاع	drop	يهبط / هبوط
increase	يزداد / زيادة	remain stable	يبقى مستقرًا
grow	ينمو	level off	يستقر بعد تغيير
climb	يصعد / يرتفع	fluctuate	يتذبذب
fall	ينخفض / انخفاض	peak	يبلغ الذروة / ذروة
decrease	يتناقص / انخفاض	reach a low	يصل إلى أدنى مستوى
decline	يتراجع / تراجع		

Lesson 3: How Big? How Fast?

slightly	بشكل طفيف	gradual	تدريجي
gradually	تدريجياً	sharp	حاد
steadily	بثبات	from ... to	من ... إلى
significantly	بشكل ملحوظ	by	بمقدار
sharply	بشكل حاد	approximately	تقريباً
dramatically	بشكل هائل	just over	أكثر بقليل من

slight	طفيف	just under	أقل بقليل من
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Lesson 4: Bigger, Smaller, the Same

higher / lower than	أعلى من / أقل من	similarly	بالمثل
the highest / the lowest	الأعلى / الأدنى	respectively	على التوالي
twice as many as	ضعف عدد	exceed	يتجاوز
compared with	مقارنةً بـ	the number of	عدد
whereas	بينما	the amount of	كمية
while	في حين	a gap between	فجوة / فرق بين
in contrast	في المقابل		

Lesson 5: Pieces of the Pie

account for	يشكّل / يمثّل	half	نصف
make up	يُكوّن	a third	ثلث
represent	يمثّل	a quarter	ربع
constitute	يشكّل (رسمي)	three quarters	ثلاثة أرباع
share	حصة	a fifth	خُمس
the majority (of)	الأغلبية	the remaining	المتبقي
a minority (of)	أقلية	percentage points	نقاط مئوية

Quick check answers

Section	Answers
1 Basics	1. the overview 2. illustrates (or compares) 3. False. Never give your opinion.
2 Trends	1. rose 2. drop 3. fluctuated 4. peaked at
3 Size and speed	1. sharp 2. from ... to 3. by 4. Just under
4 Comparing	1. amount 2. Twice as many 3. respectively 4. In contrast
5 Pie charts	1. A quarter 2. for 3. just under 4. percentage points

Remember

Overview first in your mind. **Numbers** in the body. **Compare**, don't list.

Practise with the five Graph Language apps, then use this handout to check your writing.